Appendix 3

Kinship Terminology: Consanguineal and Affinal

Skiri has two sets of kinship terms that distinguish between consanguineal and affinal relatives. Those sets of terms are presented in the tables below.[10]

Consanguineal Terms

The consanguineal terms form a small, closed set of ten dependent noun roots that are inalienably possessed for three persons—first, second, and third. The kin terms are not marked for number, since that category is coded on the verb or a modifier. The affixes are as follows:

ati-	first person possessor: 'my, our'
a-	second person possessor: 'your (SG), your (PL)'
i- ... -riʔ	third person possessor: 'his, her; their'

Two of the noun roots—mother and mother's brother—have morphologically conditioned variants (see table below). The table illustrates several generalizations:

- The merging (or neutralization) of first- and third-person forms in sibling and grandchild terms, with the third-person form being used for first person. Thus, *iraariʔ* 'his/her (same sex) sibling' is also 'my, our (same sex) sibling'.
- Several forms have also lost the initial *a* of *ati-* 'my, our', namely, the reciprocal terms for 'mother's brother' and 'nephew, niece'.
- There are two stem forms for 'mother's brother', one of which is used for first and second person possessor and the other for third person possessor. The form for 'your mother's brother', moreover, has lost the second person possessive prefix *a-* and has hardened the initial *w* of the resultant form, becoming *p* in word-initial position, following a regular phonological rule (see below).

There is in this set of consanguineal terms no parallel term for 'child'. In historical sources the noun *piiraʔuʔ* 'child' (< *piira-* 'child' + *-uʔ* NOM) is sometimes cited as a kinship term designating one's own children, those of a sibling or parallel cousin of the same sex, or matrilateral cross-cousins (i.e., children of one's mother's brother). However, this word is not specifically a kinship term; instead, it refers to any child, related or not related, and is not inflected for personal possession.

10. The data in this appendix come from the field notes of Alexander Lesser and Douglas R. Parks. Note that in the Skiri kinship terms cited here the underlying consonant cluster *kt* is written, in conformance to the convention adopted for this dictionary. In Lesser's notes, however, he consistently writes this consonant cluster as *t*, which reflects a *tt* pronunciation. In his transcriptions of South Band forms he consistently wrote *kt*.

Nevertheless, there is a descriptive verb *haa* (*ku-...ir-...*) 'be one's child; be one's offspring' that is inflected like any other descriptive verb and designates a person's child, but it, unlike the consanguineal terms below, also denotes the offspring of animals. Moreover, it is not used as a kinship term to address one's child.

Sometimes, too, the noun *tiki* 'sonny' is cited as a kinship term for 'son', but it is an appelative that is used by adults when addressing boys, who may or may not be related. A parallel term is *cuuʔat* 'daughter, dear' that is used when addressing girls.

Table 1. Skiri Kinship Terminology: Consanguineal Terms

Kin Term Root	English Translation	Basic Extended Usages	1st Possessor	2nd Possessor	3rd Possessor
-raa, *-saas*	mother	• mother's sister • father's sister and her female matrilineal descendants • father's brother's wife • female parallel cousin of father or mother	*atiraʔ*	*asas*	*isaastiʔ*
-aas	father	• father's brother • father's sister's male matrilineal descendants • mother's sister's husband • father's male parallel cousin	*atiʔas*	aʔ*as*	*i ʔaastiʔ*
-kaa	grandmother	• maternal, paternal grandmother • sister of maternal, paternal grandparent • wife of maternal, paternal grandparent's brother • parallel female cousin of maternal, paternal grandparent • father's father's sister's and mother's father's sister's female matrilineal descendants	*atikaʔ*	*akaʔ*	*ikaariʔ*
-paak	grandfather	• maternal, paternal grandfather • brother of maternal, paternal grandparent • husband of maternal, paternal grandparent's sister • parallel male cousin of maternal, paternal grandparent • father's father's sister's and mother's father's sister's male matrilineal descendants • father's sister's husband	*atipat*	*apat*	*ipaaktiʔ*
-waat	male's nephew, niece	• male's sister's son, daughter	*tiwaat*	*awaat*	*iwaahiʔ*

-waciriks, *-waariiriks*	mother's brother	• mother's male parallel cousin • male's father's mother's brother's daughter	*tiwaciriks*	*paciriks*	*iwariiriks*
-taat	sister (of male)	• male's parallel female cousin	*itaahiʔ*	*ataat*	*itaahiʔ*
-raar	sibling (of same sex as speaker)	• male's parallel male cousin • female's parallel female cousin • father's mother's brother's child (of same sex as speaker)	*iraariʔ*	*ara*	*iraariʔ*
-raac	brother (of female)	• female's parallel male cousin • female's father's mother's brother's son	*iraactiʔ*	*araac*	*iraactiʔ*
-rak-tiikis	grandchild	• brother's grandchild • sister's grandchild • mother's brother's grandchild	*raktiiki*	*arakis*	*raktiiki*

Affinal Terms

Contrasting with the consanguineal terms are those for affinal relatives, which are verb forms that are inflected like any other verb for mode, person, number, and subordination. There are three transitive verb stems that designate affinal relationships:

aktaku (ir...)	'to have as a spouse'
kaakus (ut...)	'to have as an in-law', generally used for males marrying into a family
ackurus (ir...)	'to have as a female in-law, e.g., mother-, sister-, daughter-in-law'

Each of these verb stems has two inflectional sets: one is actively (VA) and the other passively (VP) inflected. The active forms denote the perspective of the senior or dominant member of the affinal relationship, who is the agent in those forms. Thus, for the spousal set of terms the agent is the husband, the one who owns his wife, and the latter is the patient. The form *tatiiraktakuʔ*, for example, which is marked for first person agent and third person patient, translates as 'I have her as a wife' or 'she is my wife'.

In the patientive set the wife's perspective is denoted by the patient pronominal prefix, translating as the husband having her as a wife or the wife identifying that she is owned by her husband. So, for example, the form *tikuuktakuʔ* translates as either 'he has me as a wife' or 'I am his wife'.

Table 2a. Terms Designating Spouses

Skiri Forms: Indicative Mode	English translation	Skiri Forms: Gerundial Mode	English Translation
aktaku (ir...) (VA) 'to have as a wife (male speaker)' (also extended to mother's brother's wife, wife's sister, sister's son's wife)			
tatiiraktakuʔ	I have her as a wife; she is my wife	*ratiiraktaku*	the one I have as a wife; my wife
tasiiraktakuʔ	you have her as a wife; she is your wife	*rasiiraktaku*	the one you have as a wife; your wife
taaktakuʔ	he has her as his wife; she is his wife	*raaktaku*	the one he has as a wife; his wife
taciiraktakuʔ	you and I have her as a wife; she is our wife	*raciiraktaku*	the one you and I have as a wife; our wife

aktaku (ir...) (VP) 'to have as a husband (female speaker)' (also extended to husband's brother, sister's husband)			
tikuuktakuʔ	he has me as a wife; I am his wife	*rakuuktaku*	the one who has me as a wife; my husband
taaktakuʔ	he has you as a wife; you are his wife	*raaktaku*	the one who has you as a wife; your husband
taaktakuʔ	he has her as a wife; she is his wife	*raaktaku*	the one who has her as a wife; her husband
tacakuuktakuʔ	he has you and me as a wife; he is our husband	*racakuuktaku*	the one who has you and me as wives; our (IN.DU) husband
sitikuuktakuʔ	he has her and me as a wife; he is our husband	*sirikuuktaku*	the one who has her and me as a wife; our (EX.DU) husband

Table 2b. Terms Designating In-Laws: *kaakus (ut...)*

Skiri Forms: Indicative Mode	English translation	Skiri Forms: Gerundial Mode	English Translation
kaakus (ut...) (VA) 'to have as an in-law (male speaking)', ref. to one's wife's parents and brother			
tatutkaaku	I have him/her as an in-law	*ratutkaaku*	the one I have as an in-law; my in-law
tasutkaaku	you have him/her as an in-law	*rasutkaaku*	the one you have as an in-law; your in-law
tutkaaku	he has him/her as an in-law	*rutkaaku*	the one he/she has as an in-law; his/her in-law
tacuutkaaku	you and I have him/her as an in-law	*racuutkaaku*	the one you and I have as an in-law; our (IN.DU) in-law
sitatutkaaku	he and I have him/her as an in-law	*sirutkaaku*	the one he and I have as an in-law; our (EX.DU) in-law
kaakus (ut...) (VP) 'to have as a son-in-law or brother-in-law (male speaking)'			
tikuutkaaku	he/she has me as a son-in-law/brother-in-law	*rikuutkaaku*	the one who has me as a son-in-law/brother-in-law; my son-in-law/brother-in-law
tuutkaaku	he/she has you as a son-in-law/brother-in-law	*ruutkaaku*	the one who has you as a son-in-law/brother-in-law; your son-in-law/brother-in-law
tiitkaaku	he/she has him as a son-in-law/brother-in-law	*riitkaaku*	the one who has him as a son-in-law/brother-in-law; his brother-in-law/son-in-law
tacuutkaaku	he/she has you and me as sons-in-law/brothers-in-law	*racakuutkaaku*	the one who has you and me as sons-in-law/brothers-in-law
situutkaaku	he/she has him and me as sons-in-law/brothers-in-law	*siriitkaaku*	the one who has him and me as sons-in-law/ brothers-in-law

Table 2c. Terms Designating Female In-Laws: *ackurus (ir...)*

Skiri Forms: Indicative Mode	English translation	Skiri Forms: Gerundial Mode	English Translation
ackurus (ir...) (VA) 'to have as a female in-law', i.e., as a mother-in-law, daughter-in-law (male and female speaking); sister-in-law, mother's brother's wife (female speaking)			
tatiirackurus	I have her as a female in-law, as a daughter-in-law/sister-in-law	*ratiirackurusu*	the one I have as a female in-law, as a daughter-in-law/sister-in-law
tasiirackurus	you have her as a female in-law, as a daughter-in-law/sister-in-law	*rasiirackurusu*	the one who has you as a female in-law, as a daughter-in-law/sister-in-law
taackurus	she has her as a female in-law; she is her daughter-in-law/sister-in-law	*raackurusu*	the one who has her as a female in-law, as a daughter-in-law/sister-in-law
ackurus (ir...) (VP) 'to be one's female in-law', i.e., as a mother-in-law, daughter-in-law; sister-in-law, mother's brother's wife (female speaking)			
tikuuckurus	she has me as a female in-law; I am her daughter-in-law/sister-in-law	*rikuuckurusu*	the one who has me as a female in-law; i.e., my mother-in-law/sister-in-law
taackurus	she has you as a female in-law; you are her daughter-in-law/sister-in-law	*raackurusu*	the one who has you as a female in-law; your mother-in-law/sister-in-law
taackurus	she has her as a female in-law; she is her daughter-in-law/sister-in-law	*raackurusu*	the one who has her as a female in-law; her daughter -in-law/sister-in-law

There is, in addition to the affinal terms in the preceding table, another kinship term that designates an affinal relationship, *kustawihcuʔ* 'son-in-law', but it does not fit into the standard terminological pattern for affinal relatives that are inflected verbal forms. It is a noun, and even though it is not inflected for person, it is used vocatively and referentially.